

Leadership as a Black Woman

Leading fully, in your own way

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

Leadership as a Black Woman

1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Leading fully, in your own way

Reaching leadership as a Black woman often means navigating contradictory demands: be assertive but not 'aggressive', visible but not 'too much', legitimate despite the lack of role models who look like you. This double standard is real.

This guide validates what you live, helps you set down the pressure to be flawless, and build a leadership in your own image — surrounded by support.

Your intention

A challenge you face (or anticipate) in your leadership: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

The weight of the demands

Double standard, impostor feelings reinforced by the lack of role models, the burden of 'representing' a whole group: these weights don't come from a lack in you, but from a biased context.

Naming them lightens what you carry on top of everyone else.

Example

The only Black woman at her level, Aïcha felt permanently 'on display'. Naming the burden relieved her.

What I carry extra

Which demands or extra burdens do you carry (flawless, representing, etc.)?

What comes from the context

Separate: what's about you / what's about a biased context.

→ *These weights come from the context — not a lack in me.*

Thoughts under pressure

'I must be flawless', 'if I assert myself I'll be judged', 'I have no right to err': these thoughts, born of a reality, lead to exhaustion and self-censorship.

You can soften the fear without denying the double standard.

Example

Sure she had to be 'perfect', Nia was burning out. Allowing reasonable imperfection gave her energy back.

Demands journal

Note: the 'I must...' thought · what's real risk / what's amplified pressure.

My right to imperfection

Write: 'I have the right to...' (to err, to delegate, not to carry it all).

→ *I aim for excellence — not exhausting flawlessness.*

Leadership in your own image

Your leadership doesn't have to imitate a dominant model. Your authenticity, your experience, your way of rallying people are strengths — not things to erase.

Leading your way is more powerful than conforming to a mold.

Example

By stopping imitating her peers' style, Léa found a warmer leadership — and far more followed.

My leader strengths

List 5 strengths that are your own (listening, vision, resilience, connection...).

My style, owned

Write in 2-3 lines the leader you want to be, your way.

→ *My authenticity is a leadership strength.*

Building support & opening the way

Leadership isn't built alone: sponsors who champion you, networks of Black women leaders, mentoring, and strategies against bias. And in turn, you open doors for those who follow.

Building support isn't an admission of weakness: it's what all leaders do.

Example

By joining a network of Black women leaders, Sofia found role models, sponsors and advice — and stopped feeling alone.

My ecosystem

Note: 1 potential sponsor · 1 network of Black women leaders · 1 person to mentor.

My strategy against bias

Pick 1 recurring bias situation + your response strategy.

→ *Building support and opening the way multiplies my leadership.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Your leadership needn't imitate a dominant model: lean on your strengths.
- Aim for excellence, not exhausting flawlessness: allow yourself to err.
- Find sponsors and networks of Black women leaders.
- Document your wins (against erasure) and get credited.
- Choose your battles against bias; you needn't address everything.
- In turn, open the door for those who follow.

To fill in

What I carry extra

The demand / burden	What I set down

My ecosystem

Sponsor / network / mentee	Next action

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Name the weight of the demands.

Week 2 — Soften the thoughts under pressure.

Week 3 — Define my leadership in my own image.

Week 4 — Build support & open the way.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The demand I set down:
- My leader strength to own:
- The sponsor or network I enlist:

TO CLOSE

Your leadership is legitimate — lead fully, in your own way.

Your leadership is legitimate — lead in your own way.

The double standard you face as a Black woman at work is real: this guide never minimizes it. It's a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy or legal advice. If you're going through a hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.